

Derryk Whitner

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Security Operations Center Operator

Security and Operations professional with experience supporting mission-critical operations through incident management, investigations, escalation coordination, and real-time operational monitoring in fast-paced environments. Proven ability to assess situations, document incidents accurately, communicate effectively with stakeholders, and support the timely resolution of operational issues. Experienced in control room operations, customer support, root cause analysis, and maintaining composure during high-pressure events, and recognized for strong analytical thinking, attention to detail, and a commitment to operational excellence and continuous improvement.

SKILLS

Core Skills: Agile / Ticketing Systems (Jira), Automation & Process Improvement, Cross-Functional Collaboration, Customer / User Support, Documentation & Reporting, Hardware & System Troubleshooting, Incident Response & Operations, Linux & Windows Environments, Log Analysis & Troubleshooting, Process Improvement & SOP Development, Production Systems Support, Quality Control & Accuracy, Root Cause Analysis & Debugging, Scripting Fundamentals (Python), Stakeholder Communication, System Testing & Issue Identification, System Testing & Validation, Ticket Handling & Issue Tracking, Time Management & Reliability

Interests: Systems design and problem-solving through game development

PROJECTS

AI Alcohol Label Verification System

Jun 2026 - Jun 2026

Python • Streamlit • OCR • Docker • Git

- Built an AI-assisted document verification application using OCR and rule-based validation to automate alcohol label reviews.
- Reduced processing time from 30+ seconds to under 5 seconds per label through iterative optimization.
- Developed batch uploads, CSV reporting, Docker deployment, and human-in-the-loop review workflows.

Cybersecurity Risk Assessment

Jun 2026 - Jun 2026

NIST CSF • CIS Controls • Risk Analysis • GitHub

- Performed a comprehensive enterprise cybersecurity assessment using the NIST Cybersecurity Framework and CIS Controls.
- Produced professional documentation, including a control matrix, CIA mapping, risk heat map, and executive audit report.
- Prioritized remediation recommendations based on business impact and risk severity.

Blood Money (Unity)

Nov 2024 - Present

Unity • C# • Git • Debugging

- Designed and developed a commercial Unity action game featuring event-driven gameplay systems and state-based combat.
- Debugged complex gameplay interactions while improving system stability and performance.
- Managed source control, iterative testing, and feature development throughout production.
- Created a public Steam Store Page to showcase the project and prepare for community playtesting.

Steam Store Page: https://store.steampowered.com/app/3826390/Blood_Money_Trial_by_Combat/

WORK EXPERIENCE

Tesla • Austin TX

Systems Support Operations Engineer • Full-time

Feb 2024 - Aug 2025

- Performed root cause analysis on complex system and application incidents by reviewing logs, operational data, and diagnostic information to identify failures and corrective actions.
- Utilized Linux command-line tools and SCP to access systems, transfer firmware packages, review system information, and support troubleshooting activities.
- Documented system configurations, technical findings, incident resolutions, and operational risks to support engineering and operations teams.
- Leveraged Python-based tools, automation workflows, and AI-assisted analysis to improve troubleshooting efficiency, log analysis, and documentation processes.

Strategic Service Solutions Inc. • Oakland, California, United States

Seaport Terminal IT Field Engineer

Sep 2021 - Feb 2022

- Installed, configured, upgraded, and validated hardware components including memory (DIMMs), storage devices, peripherals, and workstation systems.
- Performed BIOS/UEFI and firmware update activities to support hardware compatibility, system stability, and device lifecycle management.
- Diagnosed and resolved hardware, software, operating system, and network issues through structured troubleshooting and root cause analysis.

Acuitus, Inc. • San Francisco Bay Area

IT Program Systems and Networking Intern

Feb 2021 - Feb 2022

- Configured, monitored, and administered Domain Controllers, Active Directory, File and Exchange servers, DHCP, and DNS for Windows Server 2003/2008/2012/2016 platforms.
- Troubleshoot hardware and software issues in Windows and Linux environments.

CERTIFICATIONS

LE-1: Linux Essentials

Feb 2024

Linux Professional Institute [mjause324g]

Google IT Automation with Python Specialization

Aug 2022

Coursera

Google IT Support Certificate

Oct 2021

Coursera

CompTIA A+

Jan 2024 - Jan 2027

CompTIA [RVSVRC6T1JQ418WS]

Artificial Intelligence Fundamentals

May 2026

IBM SkillsBuild

EDUCATION

Western Governors University • Bachelor of Science - BS in Cloud and Network Engineering

Jul 2026

Estimated Completion: 7/2028